4 kinds of reading question

Oct 8, 2026 · @Atin

There are 4 kinds of reading question. First, read the question. What kind is it? Then you know what to do in the text.

Picture	Kind of question	What to do	Exam questions like this
	**1. Find it**	The answer is in the text. Underline the important word in the question. Look for it in the text. The answer is near it. True or false? Is it the same as the text? "NOT" and "EXCEPT": find the one answer that is wrong.	**What time** does the library open on Saturday? / **According to** the leaflet, where can you park? / **True or false**: the market opens on Sundays. / Which of these is **NOT** free?
	**2. Big picture**	Think about all of the text, not one small part. Look at the heading and the pictures.	What is the text **mainly** about? / **Why** did Sara write this email? / **Who** is this leaflet **for**? / What is the **purpose** of this notice?
	**3. Word meaning**	Read the sentence with the word in it. Try your answer in the sentence. Does it make sense? Small words like it, they and there go back to something before.	Find a word in paragraph 2 that **means** "big". / Which word is **closest in meaning** to "cheap"? / In line 4, what does "**it**" **refer to**?
	**4. Work it out**	The answer is not in the words of the text. Look for clues, for example feeling words like happy, angry or terrible. Then think.	How does the writer **feel** about the new bus route? / Where would you **probably** see this notice? / What does the review **suggest** about the café?

Exam words: according to the leaflet = the leaflet says · EXCEPT = but not · mainly = mostly · purpose = the reason for writing · closest in meaning = almost the same meaning · refer to = talk about · probably = very likely · suggest = show, but not say

Writing your answer: "(2 marks)" = write 2 different things. "In your own words" = don't copy from the text.